



Learning Space

**IAS MAINS 2020**

**ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE**

**CASE STUDIES**

**MODULE - 17**

### CASE STUDY - 17

As a superior officer in the Indian armed forces, you take pride in training the junior officers into exemplary battle ready individuals. You are specially fond of one such officer, who is known for his skills and is considered an asset to the organisation. One day, to your utter dismay, you found out that he was honey trapped, leading to leakage of vital strategic information to the intelligence agency of an enemy nation. Taking a strict action against him attracts media attention and can damage the reputation of the organisation, which you have sworn to protect.

*What are the ethical issues involved in this case? What choices do you have in dealing with the situation? Justify your course of action. (250 words)*

# CASE STUDIES

The case narrates the recent incidents of honey trapping in navy and army.

## ETHICAL ISSUES

1

Vulnerability of human emotions  
(Despite being trained, honey trapping happened)

**VS**

Nation's security

2

Empathy towards colleagues

**VS**

Following rule of law

3

Breach of trust

**VS**

Efficient and skilled asset



# CASE STUDIES

*As a superior officer, I have following choices*

## OPTION 1

Take strict action

### MERITS

- Adhering to rule of law
- Upholding national security as supreme
- Deter other officers against breach of trust
- Strategic information leakage is stopped

### DEMERITS

- Loss of skilled asset to organization
- Image of organization gets tarnished

## OPTION 2

Warn the officer without any strict action

### MERITS

- Skilled asset is secure
- Morale of the officer is upheld
- Empathy towards colleague is served

### DEMERITS

- Creates a wrong precedent
- May result further leakage of strategic information
- Vulnerability of honey trapping other officers is increased
- National security is at risk

*Option 1 can be the right choice*

## COURSE OF ACTION

- Set up a fact finding committee as per standard operating procedures (SOPS).
- Suspend the officer and take into custody all his digital access.
- Alert Cyber Security team to check for any other similar cases.
- Report immediately to higher authorities so that suitable action be taken at appropriate level.
- Ensure image of the organisation is secured with proper handling of media.

## LONG TERM MEASURES

- Organise awareness and training camps regarding honey trapping and cyber security.
- Modernise and strengthen cyber security infrastructure for early detection and damage minimization.

## CONCLUSION

As said in Bhagavadgita, one should perform one's duty to serve what is right and just, even if it involves fighting own brothers. National security is the right and just duty, more than anything else.



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SINCERE THANKS  
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Presented by

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